Monoculture Using land for the cultivation or growth of only one type of plant or animal. This often has damaging effects on the land, as it can decrease its mineral value.

Morphology The study of the external structure of organisms.

Mutation A change of structure within an organism's DNA, which may result in a genetic transformation that gives the organism uncharacteristic traits. One example of a mutation is albinism, a lack of pigmentation.

Mutualism A situation in which two or more organisms depend on each other for survival.

Mycorrhizae Types of fungi that grow among the roots of plants and exist in a symbiotic relationship with these plants.

Natural selection The process by which characteristics that increase an organism's chances of reproducing are preferentially passed on.

Nature's contributions to people All the contributions, both positive and negative, that nature provides for people. Positive contributions, such as pollination, are also known as ecosystem services.

Niche The specific space and role that a species occupies within an ecosystem.

Omnivore An organism that feeds on both animals and plants.

Organism A general term to describe any living thing, from single-cell bacteria to complex, multicellular life-forms such as plants and animals.

Ornithology A branch of biology that concerns the scientific study of birds.

Overfishing The depletion of the fish population in a given area as a result of fishing too intensively.

Ozone layer Part of the upper level of Earth's atmosphere, with a high concentration of ozone (O_3) molecules; provides protection from ultraviolet radiation.